Living and Non-Living Things

Living things grow, need food and water, can have babies or make seeds, and respond to the world around them. People, cats, trees, kowhai flowers and worms are living.

Non-living things do not grow by themselves, do not eat or drink, and cannot have babies. A rock, a chair, a toy car and a glass of water are non-living.

Plants are living even though they do not walk around. They grow taller, they need sunlight and water, and they make seeds. A seed is alive and is waiting to grow.

Sometimes it can be tricky. A cloud moves and changes but it is not living because it does not eat, grow or have babies. Fire seems to grow and needs air, but it is not alive either.

Sorting activity: look at these things and sort them into two groups - dog, pencil, bean seed, bicycle, grass, shoe, goldfish, snow. Living: dog, bean seed, grass, goldfish. Non-living: pencil, bicycle, shoe, snow.

Remember: living things need food, water and air. We must look after living things.